r/vegan_travel • 14 дн. тому
SnooCrickets3132

We've built a free site to find vegan-friendly spots - no chains, community-ranked cities

Hey r/vegantravel,

My wife and I are vegan (she's been vegan 10+ years, I'm at 2 years) and we're from Ukraine, currently living in Belgium. We travel a lot and finding vegan spots is always a small research project.

So we built plantspack.com - a community-driven directory of vegan and vegan-friendly places worldwide. Right now there are:

- 33,000+ vegan places across 50+ countries (sourced from OpenStreetMap, verified and enriched)
- Every spot tagged as fully vegan or vegan-friendly — no chains, no Subway's sad veggie sub
- City rankings that score cities by their vegan scene (still tweaking this — small towns can outscore Berlin right now, working on it)
- Curated packs - we made ones for Rome and Barcelona, cities we actually visited. You can make your own or just store favorite spots for private trips
- 585+ recipes from 100% vegan creators with full credit and source links

But we know we're missing a ton of places - especially the spots that only locals know about. And we know that there are probably lots of wrongly mapped or closed places on the map at the moment and that's where we need community on top of automated checks to make sure that places in the directory are relevant.

We're two people with no funding, no ads. We built this because we wanted it to exist. And we hope to get as much feedback on this as possible to grow and build something genuinly useful.

If you travel and eat vegan - what would actually make this useful for you? What's missing? Would something like this have saved you time on a recent trip?

plantspack.com

37 14 Поширити

r/vegan_travel

Ви вже приєдналися

Welcome to Vegan_Travel!
Welcome to Vegan_Travel! This purpose of this community is to bring information together on where, and how, to eat vegan...

Показати більше

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Пошук коментарів

mamesama_vegan • 14 дн. тому

You sound a lot like me! My best friend and I recently built a similar app called Mame Sama but it's only for being Vegan in Japan at the moment. We're planning on launching internationally later this year. We are also no-funding, no ads. We just want to make veganism easier for everyone. I wonder if there's a way we can help each other? Thank you for your hard work!

9 Відповісти

SnooCricke... ПОЧАТКОВИЙ ДОПИСУВАЧ • 14 дн. тому

Wow, that's awesome! There are also some prominent projects in the UK and Germany/Austria (like Future Maps) that I'm aware of but haven't reached out to yet. Are you focused on a mobile app? Do you source data manually or scrape from somewhere? Now I'm getting excited :D

Let's maybe move to DMs and figure out if our visions align - if they do, I'm sure we can help each other a lot!

5 Відповісти

mypanda • 14 дн. тому

This sounds useful although I wonder how it's different from Happy Cow. I have wished in particular for something like this that focused on whole foods/plant-based (i.e. healthy vegan) options.

7 Відповісти

SnooCricke... ПОЧАТКОВИЙ ДОПИСУВАЧ • 14 дн. тому

continuously improving automated verification scripts (far from perfect for now) to keep data relevant.

There are also some nuances and social networking aspects that we are exploring, also some gamifications to make it more fun to be a part of the community, like city scores, but im general it's just an open directory with a little more variety and we want to make it completely and openly community driven without extra steps to get your review published or place claimed if you are an owner.

There is more to it, but main goal of this journey is to keep getting feedback on what people are missing in terms of digital presence and availability for vegans and incorporate it in a single or multiple platforms.

Yes, it's far from "strategic company goals" but it's a start and hopefully we will settle with something more differentiating and useful for vegan community moving forward.

4 Відповісти ···

True_Cookie1447 • 14 дн. тому

Thanks for doing this! I tried it out, most of my favorite places in 80304 (US) are there, but it has a lot of places that have closed. You could try cross-referencing your listing with another service like https://developers.google.com/maps/documentation/places/web-service/overview or something similar. Differentiating vs. Happy Cow will be important, that's my goto right now.

2 Відповісти ···

SnooCricke... ПОЧАТКОВИЙ ДОПИСУВАЧ • 13 дн. тому

Thanks, this is exactly the feedback we're looking for :) And surely the goal is to not beat Happy Cow but to create a useful alternative.

I'm planning to incorporate a google places API check to our validations to get rid of those closed places, but it can get costly, so for the start I focused on OSM mainly and websites verification, which seems to not be super efficient.

I'm glad you've found most places in Boulder present. I've jsut removed Meta Burger, that was the only 100% vegan spot according to our data. Also Vegan Fusion Culinary Academy was found closed -> It gave me an extra condition to add to our

places? I'd appreciate if you just share the names so I can add them to the platform :)

Also is there anything in particular that is missing or something you don't like on Happy Cow for you personaly? I'd appreciate "No" as well.

1 Відповісти ···

True_Cookie1447 • 13 дн. тому

Boulder is very veg friendly so most places have great vegan options, which makes it hard for fully vegan restaurant to thrive. We've had many but they've all closed. Lotus Moon is the only one, and its not showing up on your list. https://www.happycow.net/reviews/lotus-moon-vegan-pho-boulder-439708
Leaf is the only all vegetarian place in town.

Happy to help - but what are your thoughts on why it will be more useful than happycow?

2 Відповісти ···

S... ПОЧАТКОВИЙ ДОПИСУВАЧ • 13 дн. тому

Thanks for coming back with specifics - that's super helpful! I just added Lotus Moon to the platform: plantspack.com/place/lotus-moon (We've also removed 62 more places thanks to your previous feedback).

HappyCow's been around forever and has great coverage. But there are a few things we're doing differently:

- No chains: we don't list Subway or Starbucks with "vegan options." Only independent spots worth visiting.

- Community-first - feed, curated packs (trip guides), recipes from 100% vegan creators, events, sanctuaries support etc. It's meant to be a place you come back to, not just look up a restaurant (long-term goal).

- City rankings - we score and rank cities by their vegan scene. Helpful for planning trips or just seeing how your city compares (far from perfect scoring yet)

- Open data - most of our place data comes from OpenStreetMap, and we are

- Free, no ads, no paywall - HappyCow charges $3.99 for their app.

Also we have a global filter for 100% vegan vs Veg-friendly, that is workign across whole directory and is quite handy for us personaly, comparing to page-specific filtering.

But the most honest answer is: we're 2 people, 2 months in, and 11 users. We're building in public and listening to people like you to figure out what actually matters. At this stage we just hope to keep the feedback coming - it's genuinely shaping what we build next.

1 Відповісти ···

True_Cookie1447 • 13 дн. тому

>- No chains: we don't list Subway or Starbucks with "vegan options." Only independent spots worth visiting. Love that!

>- Community-first
I'm seeing your vibe and supporting that direction! ;-)

2 Відповісти ···

ПОЧАТКОВИЙ ДОПИСУВАЧ • 13 д

Appreciate it, and huge thanks for your input 🌱

1 Відповісти ···

u/Meshyai • Реклама ···

So I came back to Meshy after months away and... what happened? The mesh quality is actually insane now.

meshy.ai

Зареєструватися

xamomax • 9 дн. тому

become vegan.

Since you requested it, here is some feedback and ideas:

Maps:

For the icons, maybe add stars around it so I can see at a glace the user rating. Optionally the place name.

When mousing over, it would be nice to see details without having to click.

Add something that shows what the icons mean, so I don't have to guess what a leaf icon is supposed to represent.

A problem I often come across is "how vegan friendly is this non-vegan place?". Having a way to easily tell at a glance would be nice, as often there are no vegan spots nearby, or I am with others who refuse to go to a fully vegan place, or a giant group where it's hard to find anywhere that accommodates everyone, or someone else picked the restaurant so I would love to read someone's tip on how to survive there.

Another problem I have is how can I find a fancy place for a really great date-night worthy vegan experience, even if the restaurant is not fully vegan. Fancy places are near impossible to find without a lot of guessing. For example, I made reservations at one really high end restaurant and called ahead and they claimed that they could for sure do vegan, the chef was excited, etc., and it was a zero-effort side dish. I wish I could rank them for that so others would not make the same mistake I did.

In my particular neighborhood there is one vegan place that is rarely open (seasonal), and another vegetarian place that is absolutely horrid (rats and flies). Us Vegans know where the really good places actually are for delicious vegan dishes, even though the restaurants may not be fully vegan. You would think my neighborhood was terrible for vegans, but those of us who live here find it great, because we know where to go. I wish there was a way to capture and share that kind of data. For small towns, this is especially useful since there often is no fully vegan option. (Happy cow seemed to delete what I put the effort into documenting in that regard.)

One other thing that can be helpful for vegan travelers is a list of translations for each language / country, so we can print out a pre-translated "here is what vegan means" card to hand to a waiter or whatever.

I would also like to know what the "top vegan restaurants / experiences in the world" are, so I can plan trips to

ranking is based on "number of vegan places". That's a good start, but I want a little more nuance as in not only where the most are, but where the best are. Maybe also consider the quality / reviews of the restaurants that are there. For example, one of the cities you list indeed has a large quantity of restaurants, and I went to the majority of the ones listed, but I wouldn't really want to vacation there since none of them were travel-worthy. Another city not on your list is not really that vegan friendly in general, but they have a couple of the best vegan experiences I have ever had.

2 Відповісти ···

SnooCricket... ПОЧАТКОВИЙ ДОПИСУВАЧ • 9 дн. тому

Thank you - genuinely. This was a very useful feedback we've had and I want to be specific about what it led to.

Three of your points shipped today: there's a map legend pinned bottom-left explaining every icon and the vegan-level ring colors, hover previews on desktop so you don't have to click every pin just to see details, and star badges on markers with reviews so you can see rating at a glance.

The bigger ones I'm exploirng next, directly from your message:

- A second rating dimension on reviews - a separate "vegan experience" score - so an Osteria can legitimately show "overall 4★, vegan experience 5★" when the chef actually makes two proper mains, alongside short survival tips attached to the place ("ask for the mushroom risotto, they'll adapt")... but even so this is a big gap you pointed at, it's the one to be very careful about. For example, I'd rather not put a steakhouse on the platform, even if it has good plant-based food that requires extra-talks with the stuff.
- City rankings by quality, not just count is exactly the idea, I've improved the rankings recently from more small town-vibe towards more accessible vegan options in big cities, but to find a goldern middle we need more real customers reviews (I do not want to get them from other sources, as not sure it's reasonable).
- Fancy / date-night filtering and a small curated list of bucket-list vegan experiences worldwide is something that is technicaly possible to form in Pack already on the platform, but should be

Also we never silently delete user contributions - they're tied to your account, listed on your profile, and you can edit them at any time. Full per-contribution controls (including review history, bulk list, undo) are on my short list, but our community contribution is still to small to move it up the backlog. Overal - small towns and local knowledge is exactly where I want us to do better.

At the moment, all additions and reviews from registered users go straight to the platform, so I'd appreciate any additions and comments on the experience with that (I'm considering adding badges for trusted contributors and local experts moving forward as well).

Either way, thank you for taking the time and welcome to the pack 🌿

2 Відповісти ···

TealTofu • 14 дн. тому

Cool! Is this an app and a website, or just website?

1 Відповісти ···

SnooCricke... ПОЧАТКОВИЙ ДОПИСУВАЧ • 14 дн. тому

Just a website for now. App is in the making, but we're trying to get some feedback and interest from the community to settle the functionality and make it reasonable first. I hope to have it published during the summer.

2 Відповісти ···